Tamzid Azad

ENTREPRENEURSHIP ECOSYSTEM BUILDER | INCUBATORS | STARTUP PARTNERSHIPS | EDUCATOR

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PROFILE

Entrepreneurship ecosystem builder, educator, and technology operator with 10+ years across university venture programs, corporate innovation, and scaling businesses. Founding team member of Schulich Startups; led partnerships with the City of Toronto, Microsoft, Google, and Shopify; designed an internal incubator for 2,500 employees; and coached founders from early ideas toward product-market fit. Brings hands-on zero-to-one, commercialization, and partnership experience to help entrepreneurs build with discipline.

CORE STRENGTHS: INCUBATOR DESIGN | FOUNDER COACHING | UNIVERSITY-INDUSTRY PARTNERSHIPS | VENTURE PROGRAMMING | COMMERCIALIZATION

150+ STARTUPS SUPPORTED | 500+ SMALL BUSINESSES ENABLED | 2,500-EMPLOYEE INCUBATOR | 13-COUNTRY INNOVATION CHAMPION

ENTREPRENEURSHIP, ECOSYSTEM & TEACHING EXPERIENCE

SCHULICH SCHOOL OF BUSINESS, YORK UNIVERSITY | Instructor (part-time) Toronto | Jan 2026 - Present

- Design and deliver applied learning in communication, industry engagement, and career strategy, using guest speakers, panels, simulations, and one-to-one coaching to connect students with practice.
- Develop workshops and practical programming across entrepreneurship, product, innovation, fintech, and AI.

SCHULICH STARTUPS, SCHULICH SCHOOL OF BUSINESS | Founding Team Member & Program Manager Toronto | Dec 2019 - Jan 2021

- Designed training platforms and built industry collaborations supporting 150+ student-led startups with founder development, mentorship, and ecosystem access.
- Managed the Digital Main Street partnership with the City of Toronto, Microsoft, Google, and Shopify, helping 500+ small businesses adopt digital tools during COVID-19.

TELENOR GROUP / GRAMEENPHONE | Product Lead, New Business Innovation Norway & Bangladesh | Nov 2016 - Aug 2019

- Designed the platform, methodologies, toolkits, roadshows, and partnership model for an internal incubator launched to 2,500 employees.
- Designed and delivered rapid-prototyping and validation workshops for 10 finalist teams, coaching 30 employees with limited prior design experience to create testable concepts and validation plans.
- Won Telenor Ignite among 135 teams across 13 countries, secured USD 10K seed funding, and led Eagle Eye from concept to 30 clients, reducing customer fuel costs by 32%.

PRODUCT & COMMERCIAL OPERATING EXPERIENCE

JONAS SOFTWARE, CONSTELLATION SOFTWARE | Senior Product Manager, POS & Payments Toronto | Feb 2024 - Apr 2026

- Set strategy for a CAD 2B payments portfolio, launched Jonas Pay, designed cross-functional operating processes, and grew Mobile POS adoption by 90 clients in eight months.

COMPASS DIGITAL, COMPASS GROUP | Product Manager, Checkout & Payments Toronto | Dec 2021 - Jan 2024

- Led a cross-functional product team and payment partnerships that delivered approximately 200% year-over-year growth to 600K monthly transactions across digital hospitality platforms.

ROBI AXIATA | Product Manager, Internet of Things & Digital Services Bangladesh | Aug 2015 - Nov 2016

- Built partnerships and new commercial channels that grew an enterprise vehicle-tracking portfolio 4X in 10 months to CAD 200K in monthly revenue.

COMMUNITY & ENTREPRENEURSHIP LEADERSHIP

- Led the student entrepreneurship community as President of Schulich Ventures Club (2020-2021), creating a home for aspiring founders and venture-minded students.
- Managed the ProductTank Dhaka chapter within a global product community spanning 200+ cities; founded and managed a public-speaking training organization from 2013 to 2018.

EDUCATION & RECOGNITION

Education: MBA, Schulich School of Business, York University (2021), Lorna Wright Graduation Award; B.Sc. Computer Science & Engineering, Islamic University of Technology (2014).

Recognition: Winner, Rotman Design Challenge (2020); Bangladesh Innovation Award, Best Technology Innovation (2018); Telenor Ignite global champion (2017).